



843 CE

THE TREATY OF VERDUN

On the death of Charlemagne, his great empire was inherited by his son, who ruled as Louis the Pious for 26 years. When Louis died in 840 CE, his sons became embroiled in a civil war. After two years of bitter fighting, a division was agreed at Verdun, which gave France to Charles the Bald, the German lands to Louis, and the area in the middle (Lotharingia) to Lothar.

◁ Treaty of Verdun, miniature



804–872 CE

FUJIWARA NO YOSHIFUSA

In 858 CE, Fujiwara no Yoshifusa was appointed *sessho* (regent) to his nine-year-old grandson Seiwa. He began a line of Fujiwara regents who served as the real rulers of Japan until the mid-12th century.

848 CE **The kingdom of Pagan** is founded in Myanmar's Irrawaddy Valley by the Mranma

869 CE

850 CE **The Chola ruler Vijayala** captures the city of Tanjore in south India from the Pandyas

858 CE **Fujiwara no Yoshifusa** of Japan's influential Fujiwara clan becomes regent, beginning three centuries of Fujiwara domination



841 CE

DUBLIN SETTLED BY VIKINGS

The Irish city was initially settled as a longphort (fortified harbour) for raids inland. However, by the 850s CE it had developed into the Kingdom of Dublin under Olaf the White and his brother Ímar, whose rulers held the area, often in alliance with the Viking kingdom of York, until the 11th century.

◁ Viking war axe

▽ An early Chinese depiction of firearms in use



c. 850 CE

GUNPOWDER IS FORMULATED

Daoist monks in China, searching for the elixir of immortality, produced a formula for gunpowder. It was known that saltpetre had medicinal properties but, when mixed with sulphur and charcoal, it became combustible. In the 11th century it was used to produce the first firearms, such as flame-throwers and explosive arrows.